

## **Power of Interest**

### **Incident Reporting Policy**

**Version: 0.2**

**Approved by: Vivian Okolie**

**Approval date: 29th of July, 2026**

**Review date: July 2027**

#### **1. Purpose and Scope**

The purpose of this policy is to ensure that all unexpected incidents occurring during **Power of Interest (POI) UK** activities are identified, reported, and managed consistently. Prompt reporting protects the welfare of our young debaters, ensures legal compliance, and helps the Board of Trustees prevent future occurrences.

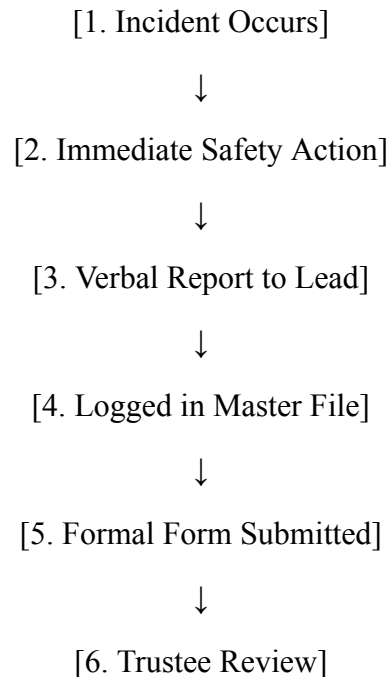
This policy applies to all physical locations (in-person tournaments, school workshops) and digital spaces (Zoom webinars, online debate rooms, Discord servers) operated by POI UK. It covers all trustees, directors, student coaches, judges, and visiting school teams.

#### **2. Definition of an "Incident"**

For the purposes of POI UK, a reportable incident is any unplanned event that results in, or has the potential to cause, harm, disruption, or loss. Incidents are categorized into four core areas:

- **Safeguarding / Welfare:** Allegations or suspicions of child abuse, neglect, self-harm, grooming, or severe bullying involving minor participants (Years 7–13).
- **Health and Safety:** Physical injuries, slips, trips, medical emergencies, or property damage occurring at an in-person debate tournament venue.
- **Equity and Conduct:** Explicit discrimination, harassment, hate speech, or severe breaches of the POI UK Code of Conduct during a debate session.
- **Data Security and Finance:** Loss of physical documents, digital data leaks (GDPR breaches), or suspected theft/fraud of tournament entry fees.

### 3. The Incident Reporting Workflow



#### Step 1: Immediate Action (Make Safe)

The absolute priority is the immediate safety and well-being of those involved. If required:

- Administer basic first aid or contact emergency services (999/112).
- In a digital workshop, immediately remove or mute any user violating code of conduct boundaries.

#### Step 2: Internal Notification

- **Standard Incidents:** Report the event verbally to the on-site **Tournament Convenor** or **Online Session Lead** as soon as it is safe to do so, and no later than the end of the event day.
- **Critical Safeguarding Issues:** If the incident involves a child at risk, bypass standard channels and contact the **Designated Safeguarding Lead (DSL)** immediately.

#### Step 3: Completing the Incident Report Form

The person who witnessed or first responded to the incident must complete a formal **POI UK Incident Report Form** (see Appendix A) within **24 hours** of the occurrence. Send the completed form to: [contact@poi.org.uk](mailto:contact@poi.org.uk)

### 4. Response Timelines & Escalation

Once received by the operational leadership team, incidents are triaged based on severity:

| <b>Severity Level</b> | <b>Example Scenario</b>                                                                     | <b>Internal Action Timeline</b>                                                               | <b>External Escalation</b>                                                          |
|-----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Low</b>            | Minor trip with no injury; brief technical disruption during an online webinar.             | Logged in master file within <b>48 hours</b> . Reviewed at next team meeting.                 | None required.                                                                      |
| <b>Medium</b>         | Verbal altercations violating equity rules; an injury requiring basic first aid.            | Investigated by a Director within <b>3 working days</b> . Written summary produced.           | Inform the participant's school/parents.                                            |
| <b>High</b>           | Severe physical injury requiring hospitalisation; data breach; child protection allegation. | <b>Immediate escalation</b> to Board of Trustees. Action plan formed within <b>24 hours</b> . | Emergency services, Charity Commission, or Information Commissioner's Office (ICO). |

## **5. Serious Incident Reporting to Regulators**

As a UK organisation operating under charity governance frameworks, the Board of Trustees is legally obligated to report "Serious Incidents" to the **Charity Commission for England and Wales**. A report must be made if the incident results in a significant loss of funds, a significant risk to the charity's reputation, or serious harm to beneficiaries.

## **6. Confidentiality and Record Keeping**

Incident reports contain highly sensitive personal data. They must be stored securely on a restricted-access digital drive managed strictly by the Board of Directors. Records must be maintained in compliance with UK GDPR and the Data Protection Act 2018 and retained for a minimum of **7 years** (or longer if legal proceedings or safeguarding inquiries apply).

## Appendix A:

### POI UK Incident Report Form (Template)

|                                     |                                                     |
|-------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| <b>1. GENERAL INFORMATION</b>       |                                                     |
| <b>Date &amp; Time of Incident:</b> |                                                     |
| <b>Location of Incident:</b>        | [ Name of School Venue, Room Number, or Zoom Link ] |
| <b>Name of Person Reporting:</b>    |                                                     |
| <b>Contact Details:</b>             |                                                     |

|                                                           |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>2. TYPE OF INCIDENT (Tick all that apply)</b>          |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Health & Safety / Injury         |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Equity Breach / Harassment       |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Property Damage / Financial Loss |

|                                                                                                                                                          |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>3. INCIDENT DETAILS</b>                                                                                                                               |
| <b>Names of individuals involved (Include whether they are students, volunteers, or teachers):</b>                                                       |
|                                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>Describe exactly what happened (Be factual. State what you saw and heard. Avoid speculation):</b>                                                     |
|                                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>What immediate actions were taken to manage the situation? (e.g., First aid applied, student moved to a quiet room, user removed from Zoom call):</b> |
|                                                                                                                                                          |

|                                                                         |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                                                                         |
| <b>Were there any witnesses? (If yes, list names and contact info):</b> |
|                                                                         |

|                                   |                                                                  |
|-----------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>4. SIGNATURE &amp; ROUTING</b> |                                                                  |
| <b>Signature of Reporter:</b>     | _____ <b>Date:</b> _____                                         |
| <b>Action Taken by Director:</b>  | [ For Internal Board Use Only: Actions, Referrals, Date Closed ] |

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